IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and
as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend
for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old],

Plaintiff,

v. Case No.: 2025-CA-10255

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
COURT, CLERK OF THE COURT
FOR THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL
CIRCUIT, GINA JUSTICE (AND/OR
CURRENT COURT ADMINISTRATOR),
CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C.
SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS,
JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX, MIKE MOORE,

Defendants.

_____/

DEFENDANTS' RESPONSE AS TO RECORDS PRODUCED AS PER ORDER ON "PLAINTIFF'S NOTICE OF DEFENDANTS' NONCOMPLIANCE WITH THE AUGUST 27, 2026 ORDER AND MOTION TO COMPEL SWORN IDENTIFICATION AND IN CAMERA TENDER OF WITHHELD RECORDS"

Defendants, THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT, TRIAL COURT ADMINISTRATOR GINA JUSTICE, CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS, and JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX, (hereinafter "Defendants"), by and through undersigned counsel, hereby files this Response as ordered by the Court in the September 28, 2026, order.

In the Order ***"ORDER ON "PLAINTIFF'S NOTICE OF DEFENDANTS' NONCOMPLIANCE WITH THE AUGUST 27, 2026 ORDER AND MOTION TO COMPEL***

SWORN IDENTIFICATION AND IN CAMERA TENDER OF WITHHELD RECORDS" the Court has ordered the Defendants to comply with several directives:

1. the Court ORDERS Defendants to file proof of transmission of the documents to the Court within three (3) days of this Order.
2. Defendants are ORDERED to, within seven (7) days, file and serve a certification by the records custodian or the custodian's designee, sworn under penalty of perjury, stating, after reasonably inquiry:
   (i) whether records responsive to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, scheduling and attendance categories exist;
   (ii) if records within those categories exist and were not produced, the reason they were withheld; and
   (iii) whether the list of withheld records in Defendants' Amended Response is complete as to every record responsive to Plaintiffs requests.
3. The Court ORDERS Defendants to produce every non-exempt responsive record in the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, categories to the Plaintiff within seven (7) days. If such records have already been produced, Defendants are ORDERED to file a response stating as such and indicating when such records were produced and how such records were transmitted to Plaintiff.
4. the Court ORDERS Defendants to produce to the Court within seven (7) days of this Order a current cumulative index of all records withheld.
5. Defendants are to redact only the confidential portion and produce the remainder directly to Plaintiff, is to be undertaken by the Court as part of its in-camera inspection.

The Court ordered Defendants to file proof of transmission of the documents to the Court within three (3) days of this Order. This was completed with the proof filed on September 29, 2026. DIN 103.

Defendants are ordered to, within seven (7) days, file and serve a certification by the records custodian or the custodian's designee, sworn under penalty of perjury, stating, after

reasonably inquiry: (i) whether records responsive to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, scheduling and attendance categories exist; (ii) if records within those categories exist and were not produced, the reason they were withheld; and (iii) whether the list of withheld records in Defendants' Amended Response is complete as to every record responsive to Plaintiffs requests. This has been completed and is attached to this filing as Exhibit A.

The Court ordered Defendants to produce every non-exempt responsive record in the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, categories to the Plaintiff within seven (7) days. If such records have already been produced, Defendants are ordered to file a response stating as such and indicating when such records were produced and how such records were transmitted to Plaintiff. Accordingly, the records responsive to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, scheduling and attendance categories were available to Plaintiff on August 21, 2025. (Exhibit B) As evidenced in the letter (Exhibit B), Plaintiff was required to remit payment, via check or money order, to obtain the documents. Plaintiff had the option to pick up the records from the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Courthouse or have the items mailed to his listed address, Plaintiff opted to pick up the records. Accordingly, the records were filed in this case as Exhibits to the Writ of Mandamus. DIN 6.

Additionally, the Court ordered Defendants to produce to the Court within seven (7) days of this Order a current cumulative index of all records withheld. That index was provided to the Court in the "DEFENDANTS' RESPONSE TO CONFIDENTIALITY AS PER ORDER ON "PLAINTIFF'S MOTION FOR SANCTIONS AND ENTRY OF PEREMPTORY WRIT OF MANDAMUS, OR ALTERNATIVELY, FOR WRITTEN ORDER WITH FINDINGS SETTING EVIDENTIARY HEARING" AND ORDER ON "PLAINTIFF'S COMBINDED MOTION FOR INTERLOCUTORY RECONSIDERATION, REHEARING UNDER FLA. R. CIV. P. 1.530(g),

AND CLARIFICATION ON ORDERS AT DOCKET 80 AND 81"" and again in the "DEFENDANTS' FIRST AMENDED RESPONSE TO CONFIDENTIALITY AS PER ORDER ON "PLAINTIFF'S MOTION FOR SANCTIONS AND ENTRY OF PEREMPTORY WRIT OF MANDAMUS, OR ALTERNATIVELY, FOR WRITTEN ORDER WITH FINDINGS SETTING EVIDENTIARY HEARING" AND ORDER ON "PLAINTIFF'S COMBINDED MOTION FOR INTERLOCUTORY RECONSIDERATION, REHEARING UNDER FLA. R. CIV. P. 1.530(g), AND CLARIFICATION ON ORDERS AT DOCKET 80 AND 81."" Those items are listed below and were provided to the Court for in-camera review via FedEx. The documents were delivered to chambers on September 21, 2026. (Exhibit C)

The records are identified below with the date, author, recipient, and general subject matter:

(1) Date- April 28, 2025; Author-Assistant Court Counsel; recipient-Judge DePaul; and general subject matter- judicial recusal. This document is confidential under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(1).

(2) Date- April 28, 2025; Author- Judge DePaul; recipient- Assistant Court Counsel; and general subject matter- judicial recusal. This document is confidential under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(1).

(3) Date- April 28, 2025; Author-Assistant Court Counsel; recipient-Judge DePaul and Judicial Assistant; and general subject matter- judicial recusal. This document is confidential under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(1).

(4) Date- April 28, 2025; Author-Judicial Assistant; recipient-Judge DePaul and Assistant Court Counsel; and general subject matter- judicial recusal. This document is confidential under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(1).

(5) Date- April 28, 2025; Author- Judge DePaul; recipient- Assistant Court Counsel and Judicial Assistant; and general subject matter- judicial recusal. This document is confidential under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(1).

These withheld records will be redacted and produced to Plaintiff via FedEx to his address of [redacted] Tampa, FL [redacted] Proof of mailing will be filed upon confirmation of delivery.

CONCLUSION

WHEREFORE, Defendants, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court, and Trial Court Administrator Gina Justice, Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella, Judge Kelly Ayers, and Judge Matthew Felix respectfully respond to this Honorable Court's Order.

Respectfully Submitted,

JAMES UTHMEIER
ATTORNEY GENERAL

/s/ *Jessica Schwieterman*
Jessica Schwieterman
Senior Assistant Attorney General
Florida Bar No. 116460
Office of the Attorney General
3507 E. Frontage Road, Suite 200
Tampa, FL 33607
T - (813) 233-2880; F - (813) 281-1859
Jessica.Schwieterman@myfloridalegal.com
Counsel for Defendants 13th Judicial Circuit, Trial Court Administrator Gina Justice, Chief Judge Sabella, Judge Ayers, and Judge Felix

CONFERRAL STATEMENT

I certify that conferral prior to filing is not required under rule 1.202.

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I hereby certify that on October 5, 2026, I electronically filed the foregoing with the Clerk of Court by using the Florida Courts eFiling Portal.

/s/ *Jessica Schwieterman*
Jessica Schwieterman
Senior Assistant Attorney General

EXHIBIT
A

IN THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and
as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend
for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old],

Plaintiff,

v. Case No.: 2025-CA-010255

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
COURT, CLERK OF THE COURT
FOR THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL
CIRCUIT, GINA JUSTICE (AND/OR
CURRENT COURT ADMINISTRATOR),
CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C.
SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS,
JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX, MIKE MOORE,

Defendants.

_____/

CERTIFICATION

I, RICHARD T. MELENDI, certify as follows:

1. My name is RICHARD T. MELENDI. I am over eighteen (18) years of age, I am competent, and I have personal knowledge of the facts and information provided herein.

2. I am the Chief Deputy Court Administrator of Operations for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit of Florida and make this certification as the designee of the custodian of the administrative records of the judicial branch for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, in compliance with paragraph two (2) of the Court's September 28, 2026, "Order on 'Plaintiff's Notice of Defendants' Noncompliance with the August 27, 2026 Order and Motion to Compel Sworn Identification and In Camera Tender of Withheld Records.''

3. This certification is based on the record searches I requested be performed by the Honorable Kelly Ayers and her judicial assistant.

4. At my request, a search was conducted to determine if records responsive to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, scheduling and attendance categories existed. The search generated records totaling 226 pages. Therefore, records responsive to both categories exist.

5. The records located pursuant to the searches conducted for the December 13, 2024, and the January 9, 2025, scheduling and attendance categories have been provided to Plaintiff.

6. Based on reasonable inquiry, the cumulative index of withheld records filed with the Court is complete as to the records withheld in response to Plaintiff's records request dated August 14, 2025. The records responsive to the December 13, 2024, or January 9, 2025, scheduling and attendance categories do not appear on that index because no record produced in response to the related searches was withheld.

Richard T. Melendi
Chief Deputy Court Administrator of Operations
Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, State of Florida

STATE OF FLORIDA }

COUNTY OF HILLSBOROUGH }

BEFORE ME, the undersigned Notary Public, this day appeared Richard T. Melendi, who is personally known to me or who has provided proper identification in the form of Personally Known, and he acknowledged under oath that he executed the foregoing certificate freely and voluntarily.

SWORN AND SUBSCRIBED TO before me this 5th day of October, 2026.

NOTARY PUBLIC

Marilza de souza e silva
Signature of Notary

Marilza de souza e silva
Printed Name of Notary

My Commission Expires 02-06-2029

NOTARY PUBLIC STATE OF FLORIDA
MARILZA DE SOUZA E SILVA
Commission # HH 637775
Expires February 6, 2029

EXHIBIT
B

ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE OF THE COURTS

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT OF FLORIDA

CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA
CHIEF JUDGE

GINA JUSTICE
COURT ADMINISTRATOR

August 21, 2025

Mr. Christopher Hanson
[redacted]
Tampa, FL [redacted]

Re: Public Records Request – *Hanson v. Hanson, Case No.: 24-DR-1150, Family Law, Division D.*

Dear Mr. Hanson:

This letter serves as a collective response to your three (3) public record requests directed to our Public Information Officer, Mike Moore, via email dated July 25, 2025.

As a preliminary matter, Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not apply to records of the judicial branch of government. *See* Times v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 255 (Fla. 1995) (determining the judicial branch of government is not an "agency" subject to Chapter 119, Florida Statutes). However, we are treating your public records request as a request for administrative records of the judicial branch in accordance with Florida Rule of General Practice and Judicial Administration 2.420 and article 1, section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

Florida Rule of General Practice and Judicial Administration 2.420(m) provides the procedure for public access to Judicial Branch records. According to Rule 2.420(m)(3), fees for judicial records are the same as provided in section 119.07, Florida Statutes. Section 119.07(4)(a)1. authorizes the assessment of $.15 per page.

The nature of your requests did result in the generation of records that meet your requests. The number of records located totals 226 pages. As such, prior to furnishing the records you requested, our office will need to receive advance payment for the copies of the records, including shipping, depending on the method of delivery you choose.

10/15/2025 10:47 AM Electronically Filed: Hillsborough County/13th Judicial Circuit Page 13

Below are the responses to each of the three requests contained in your email dated July 25, 2025:

A copy of all visual and audio recordings from the following hearings in Case No. 24-DR-1150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson, Division D, including both live and Zoom formats:

- There are no records satisfying this request related to the following hearings – Docket #90 – December 19, 2024, Docket #109 – January 9, 2025, Docket #118 – January 21, 2025, Docket #152 – February 12, 2025, Docket #155 – October 28, 2024, Docket #158 – December 13, 2024, and Docket #192 – April 22, 2025.
- A video record does exist satisfying this request, specifically, Docket #198 – April 4, 2025 hearing. However, in accordance with Florida law, surveillance video footage from security cameras located on and within courthouse facilities in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is confidential and exempt from public record disclosure. See Fla. R. Admin. 2.420(c)(8); Fla. Stat. §119.071(3)(a); Op Att'y Gen. Fla. 2015-06 (2015). Confidential surveillance video footage may be released only as authorized by §119.071(3)(a)3., Fla. Stat.

A copy of all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Ayers, her judicial assistant (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the December 13, 2024 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-11550, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, requesting all of these materials from December 1, 2024 to December 20, 2024, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and attendance at the hearing on December 13, 2024.

- Records do exist that satisfy this request.

A copy of all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Ayers, her judicial assistant (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the January 9, 2025 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-11550, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, requesting all of these materials from December 21, 2024 to January 20, 2025, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and attendance at the hearing on January 9, 2025.

- Records do exist that satisfy this request.

In order to receive the records associated with your request, please submit a check for the total amount of $33.90, made payable to Hillsborough County Board of County Commissioners. After your check has been received and processed, my assistant Christine Cuenin-Wilson will call you to arrange a time for you to pick up the records at the George Edgecomb Courthouse.

Alternatively, we can ship the records satisfying your request to the following address - [redacted] Tampa, FL [redacted] after we receive and process a check in the amount of $44.85, as outlined in the table below, made payable to Hillsborough County Board of County Commissioners.

DESCRIPTION	QUANTITY	RATE	COST
Black & white copy, 8 ½" x 11" page	226	$.15	$33.90
Shipping	1	$10.95	$10.95
TOTAL COST			**$44.85**

Sincerely,

Gina Justice
Court Administrator

GJ/rtm

cc: The Honorable Kelly A. Ayers, Circuit Court Judge
Dwauna Heyward, Judicial Assistant

EXHIBIT
C

From: FedEx Tracking
To: Jessica Koster
Subject: You"re getting a shipment 877377751929
Date: Thursday, September 17, 2026 4:23:56 PM

This Message Is From an External Sender
This message came from outside your organization.

You’re getting a shipment.

Tracking details

Tracking ID	877377751929
From	Attorney Generals Office 3507 E Frontage Rd, 200 Tampa, FL, US 33607
To	Honorable Judge Coleman - UFC Sec 6 Pinellas County Justice Center 14250 49th Street North Annex Bldg., Suite J3.210 Clearwater, FL, US 33762
Number of pieces	1
Total shipment weight	1.00 LB
Service	FedEx Ground
Reference	Tampa
Department number	Tampa
Invoice number	2025-CA-10255
Purchase order number	AG L25-4-3055

TRACK SHIPMENT

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All weights are estimated.

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ID 1030

From: FedEx Tracking
To: Jessica Koster
Subject: Your shipment was delivered 877377751929
Date: Monday, September 21, 2026 1:17:57 PM

This Message Is From an External Sender
This message came from outside your organization.

Your shipment was delivered.

Delivery Date

Mon, 09/21/2026
1:07pm

Get alerts on future deliveries

Stay informed with delivery notifications for all your shipments. You can also share delivery instructions and manage your delivery.

SIGN UP

Delivered to

14250 49TH ST N, Clearwater, FL 33762

Received by

NWILSON

Report missing package

How was your delivery?

Tracking details

Tracking ID	877377751929
From	Ariel Abreu Attorney Generals Office 3507 E Frontage Rd, 200 Tampa, FL, US 33607
To	Honorable Judge Coleman - UFC Sec 6 Pinellas County Justice Center 14250 49th Street North Annex Bldg., Suite J3.210 Clearwater, FL, US 33762
Ship date	Fri 9/18/2026 12:00 AM
Number of pieces	1
Total shipment weight	1.00 LB
Service	FedEx Ground
Reference	Tampa
Department number	Tampa
Invoice number	2025-CA-10255
Purchase order number	AG L25-4-3055

TRACK SHIPMENT

Track your package and see when it's coming

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ID 1026